

Be passionate! Show Enthusiasm. Energy. Reliability. Confidence.

Questions

Project Info (title, budget, company, connection, dates, etc)

How did they find me? Have you seen my reel? Any particular favorites?

How did the team come together producers et al?

Tell me about *your film*? What inspired the movie? Have heard plenty about where it came from.

Them:

My comments and initial reaction and thoughts:

Tell me about the feature/film/story you are writing?

General Questions / Relate

What is your vision for the film? Aspirations? Visually? Feeling? Mode?

Why is the film important and what does it mean to you?

Who is the audience for the film? Where do you see it being most successful? What avenues?

What is our favorite scene? Or Episode? Which one nailed the aesthetic you were reaching for? What would you do differently going into the feature?

My favorite scene is:

...

Tone, Look, Style?

Lighting, Color Palette, Contrast,
Composition, Aspect Ratio, Negative Space, Centered, Symmetry or NO,
Lensing, Atmosphere, Depth, Texture, Details, Environment+Location, Character
Movement, Pacing (Intro, Hold, Frenetic),
Core Story, Big Picture
Visual References

My initial ideas:

My initial ideas:

Discovery. Process. Questions. And we are reaching for the answers. Continually evolving guide.

We really need to define the visual language for the film overall, then have fun diving into the details of each movement and our characters' experience. Finding ways to extract/heighten their emotion and emphasize the subtext. Have the camera/light follow the rhythm of the film and emotion.

Visual Notes

- Notes about initial ideas, look, feel, things that struck me, etc. Thinking through all the things listed above in Tone, Look, Style. I'll fill out as much as possible or just the broad strokes. Sometimes there's a lot, sometimes nothing.

Those are the broad strokes and initial instincts. I would love to dive in with you about your vision, any specifics, images, and references. Explore each aspect of the script in depth. **PROCESS**

REFERENCE IMAGES - link to google drive folder where I collected images. Sometimes it's one folder, sometimes I have enough time to organize it into lighting, composition, etc.

Sections + Places (EXAMPLES)

Lenses & Formats - Notes on thoughts about this if there are any. Otherwise, just a general explanation to a director about how lenses can impress and impart a look - Through chromatic and spherical aberration, contrast, glare, Edge sharpness and fall off, Depth of field, Selective and tilt shift focus. Hyperfocus at moments. Dolly zooms. We can really put a stamp on our visuals. Through tests we can hone in on which specific lenses give us the look and feel we want for the film.

I am still wrapping my head around it all and as we dive deeper into conversations about the film and chip away at it and find the core, these things will become clearer.

anamorphic images - https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ZzP6aRcCC-fSxPFLwZhliUk_vj4Kt95E

spherical images - https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/19bb_jN9pXre_OaqPrye5EmQ6Y1hPhrcP

Movement - there's a mix of movement - dolly, steadicam, zoom, and handheld. But also whip pans, focus pulls, and more.

Composition.

Each Character's personality. How do we heighten, reflect, and emphasize that:

...

In case it's useful: Spherical vs. Anamorphic resources -

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rWAp4Fv9RvE> // <https://vimeo.com/299382632> //

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KAn1wB72rvY> (a bit aggressive for these specific lenses, but a good guide on the difference with spherical)

What does this film feel like? Look like? References? Similar? Other films, art, tv, anime, etc.

References (Filmmaker):

References (Bongani):

Visual

Mood

Execution

Specific Parts of Script

Cinematographers and Painters and Artists that come to mind

Etc

Is there are rhythm to the cut, edit, pacing? What is the speed of the film?

Songs & Music? That you listened to while writing?

How far along are you in your process? Script / Story / Outline / Moments.

How much more development + open to notes?

How much more development + open to notes?

Planned dates & schedule?

Plans to execute difficult portions of the story/script/doc?

(Car chases, fantastic creature effects, houses burning down, scenes written as single-takes, etc)

My thoughts:

Distribution? Screenings? First Feature Directing? Co-directing?

How much and what kind of prep do they do?

How many weeks of prep do you have planned?

Prep right away

Has any location scouting happened yet?

Location vs. Studio?

Casting updates?

Favorite artist or photographer. Favorite DP. Favorite films

Them:

My favorite Directors: Wong Kar Wai, Park Chan Wook, Barry Jenkins, Ryan Coogler, Cuarón, Innaritu,

My favorite DPs: Roger Deakins, Christopher Doyle, Xiaoding Xiao, Rodrigo Prieto, Chung Hoon Chung, Bob Richardson, Bradford Young

What kind of equipment have you thought about using or is that all up to me?

Preferred camera, film stock, lighting setups, and looks?

What are your hopes and goals for the film and how can I help you achieve that?

As a creative on this film, what is the most critical thing to understand about the story and/or the characters?

Previous DP? Ask why they're looking for a new one and not working with one that they have a preexisting relationship with.

My Ideas

Lighting & camera movement.

Core Story Character

Interviews

Details and Texture

Larger Picture

My Value

Story is King. Collaborating. I like getting involved early on.

Camera tech, lighting techniques, fun to be around

Connection to great crew

Creative, problem solver, funny, good vibe, good with actors,

First Time Director - really good with them.

PRODUCER (+ director)

Budget? Days to shoot? 22 days

All Creatures - 1.2 million - DP

Woodshock - 5 million - 2nd Unit DP, b-camera operator

Brightburn - 10 million - b camera additional photography

Commercials - plenty of higher budgets, a few union commercials Southwest, car spot.

The Four - Diddy, Khaled, Fergie, Megan Trainor - Op. FOX. Huge crew. Tabletop.

Hasbro SuperSoaker - DP

Southwest Airlines - DP

Pepsi - Barry Peterson - Op

Crew size? Crew Rates. OT after 12. Resources.

Union Minimum staffing

Camera - DP, Operator, 1st AC, 2nd AC, Loader, DIT w/kit.

Electric - Gaffer, BBE, Electric

Grip - Key Grip, BBG, Grip

In our case:

I really enjoy operating, so would love to try get a waiver.

A-camera/B-camera operator who Steadicams

Steadicam and Speciality days (steadi, techno, gimbal, etc)

Man up on certain days, especially in grip electric.

NIGHTS (Venue, Exterior . May need condors, may need ballon, etc)

Potential rigging crew when needed

On most days we can get by with a crew of: _____

Through networking and some producing contacts, I have some connections to some great crew.

Get in touch with crew early:

1st AC for sure. Possibly Gaffer, depending on people's availability. Maybe Operator.

Crew I like in mind:

Wishlist:

Equipment Budget?

Early thoughts:

Camera Truck. Electric Truck. Grip Truck. Faster load ins
DIT w/kit

Alexa Mini

Anamorphic Primes + Two Zooms (long and short) (Panavision. T series. Detuned G. Primos)

Spherical lens set, possibly Tilt Shift on certain days

Spherical lenses for VFX run of show

Filters

Skypanels, Litemats, a few big units for pushing through frames and night work.

Occasion balloons, condors, etc for night.

Luminaire / Wireless DMX / or Ratpac, etc for control during shots that need it and light effects

Dollies, Sliders, Speciality: techno, gimbal, etc.

Vendors: Panavision, Keslow, Otto Nemenz. Vantage/Clairmont subrentals for lens filters.

Whitepoint Optics. Tribe 7 for Blackwing.

Would love to do some extensive lens **Testing** and detuning. Anamorphic + Spherical. Customized lens.

Test our post process as well (Fotokem Alastor Arnold or EFilm Andre Rivas) and create a show **LUT**.

Large Format? Large Format anamorphic? Large format for POV!?

Logistics I should know now?

Days?

Location considerations and access?
Stage/Studio vs. Location?

VFX? Will we have a supervisor and partner. How early will they get involved?

Please can we have a killer Art Department. Designer, On Set Dresser?

~~AD and whether I can influence their choice of that person. I warn them that if I don't have a strong AD
How much and what kind of prep do they do?~~

Storyboard Artist?

Keeping set intimate. Regardless of how big the crew gets.

How did they find me? Have you seen my reel? Any particular favorites?

Producer expectations for a successful working relationship with DP?

STORY QUESTIONS

What drew you to this particular story?

What are your hopes and goals for the short and how can I help you achieve that?

As a creative on this film, what is the most critical thing to understand about the story and/or the characters?

Director & Producer

Budget? Crew size? Crew Rates. OT after 12.

Art Department. Designer, On Set Dresser

AD and whether I can influence their choice of that person. I warn them that if I don't have a strong AD

Equipment Budget?

Logistics I should know now?

Days?

Location considerations and access?

How much and what kind of prep do they do?

For interviews, I will make a deck of about 30-40 images that display the mood, texture and colors of how I imagine the film to look. If the director is nodding and reacting to a majority of them, then I know we are creatively on the same page, and gives us a good starting point to discussing the tools to execute that vision.

REAP RICH - Research the people and company / Update resume & links / be tenacious / dress well for the interview / arrive early / be warm and friendly / be enthusiastic / Results and achievements / energy / positive attitude / grit tenacity / take ownership / mention awards, successful budget, special tech results / light up the room when you walk in / process / how did you get there / show your creativity / relationships, mention your ability to form great relationships / how you work with director and crew / bring beneficial contacts and people / who has a connection to this current job / interview the interviewer / pre-close, remind of your results / closing, ask next steps of interview process, follow up / really enjoy our time today / anything else you want to know or would like me to cover / humanity, tell me about you / thank you notes

STORY QUESTIONS